

Verdant Grocers ? Near-Real-Time Inventory Visibility (Phase 1 of a controlled test)

Scenario

Verdant Grocers is a regional chain. Store managers currently reorder from a report that is refreshed overnight, so a product that sells out at 10 AM is not visible as out-of-stock to the replenishment team until the next morning.

What is known:

- 140 stores across three states.
- Each store has point-of-sale terminals that already emit a transaction event per basket. The events reach an on-premises message broker today.
- Roughly 900,000 basket events per day across the chain, with a pronounced weekday-evening peak.
- The merchandising team wants store-level stock positions visible "within a few minutes" of a sale, and has said that a figure closer to one minute would change how they staff replenishment.
- There is an existing overnight batch warehouse that finance depends on. It cannot be switched off, and finance's monthly close must not regress.
- The company has two full-time data engineers. There is no platform team.
- Leadership has said it does not want to be "locked into one vendor", but has not defined what that means in practice.

What is deliberately not stated

1. How much event loss, if any, is acceptable during an outage.
2. Any budget or cost ceiling.
3. Any regulatory or compliance regime that applies.